YOUR MAGAZINE FROM GALLIONS

thamesview

NEWS • EVENTS • COMPETITIONS

OCTOBER 2012
www.gallionsha.co.uk



BENEFITS CAP- WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

INTERVIEW WITH GALLIONS' NEWEST BOARD MEMBER, NIGEL BARNES

HALF-TERM BOREDOM BUSTER ACTIVITIES

Gallions Housing Association

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WELCOME

Autumn is now in full swing. The kids are back to school and it's that time of year when everyone gets back into their regular routines. If you find that you've settled into your schedule and you have a night or so spare, Gallions is looking for more residents to get involved. On page 24-25 you will find a list of resident groups you can join, meet new people, help your community and have fun while you're at it!

October half term is coming up and to help relieve any boredom Trust Thamesmead is putting on a week of 'boredom buster' activities, read more on page 26.
Gallions wanted to take the opportunity to highlight our STAR survey results (page 20) our average satisfaction rate has increased since 2007, with an average score of 80%!

We also wanted to introduce Gallions' newest Board Member, Nigel Barnes, read more about who he is and what motivated him to become a member of our board on page 22.

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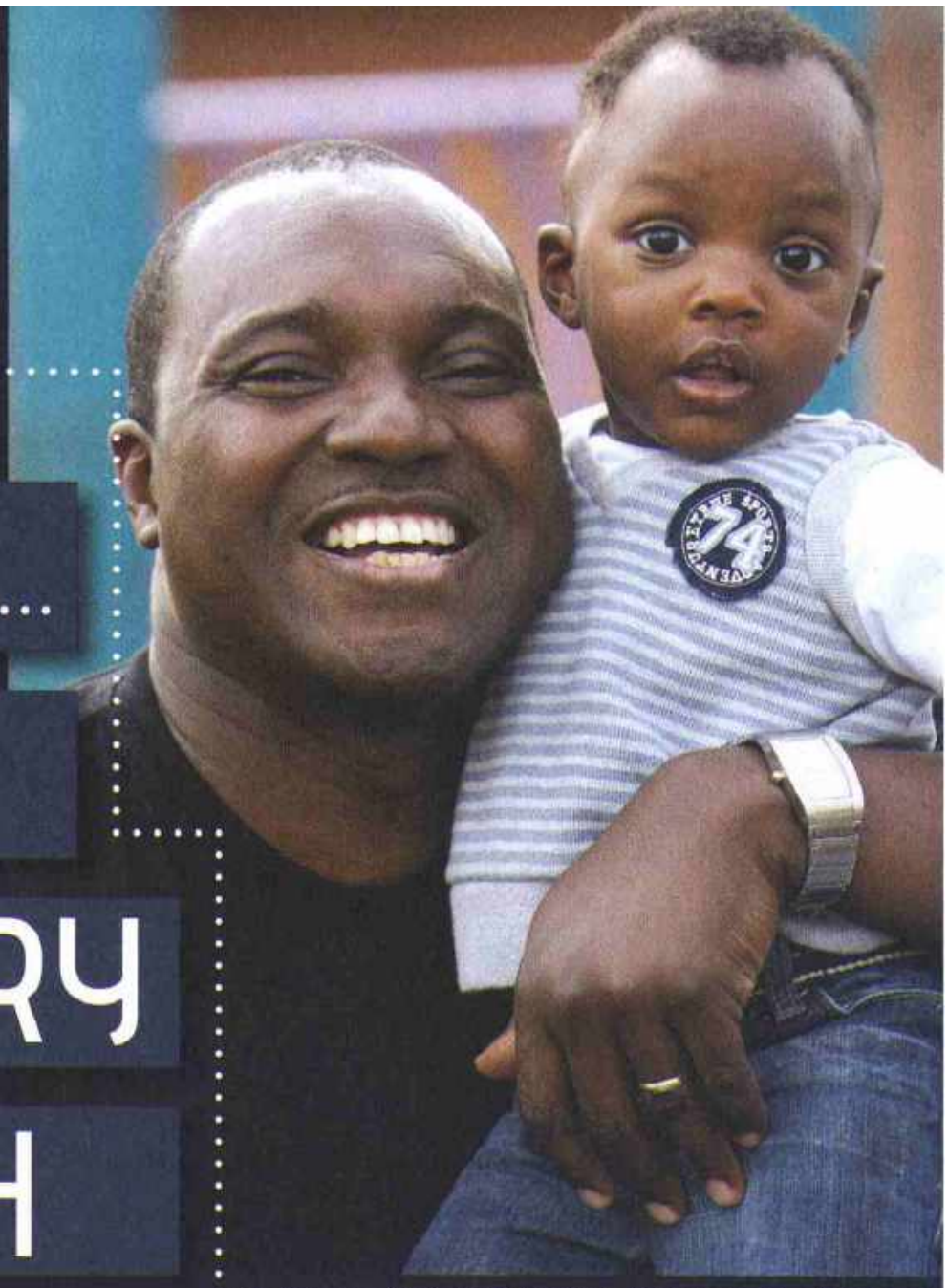
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Gallions Residents Group

Gallions Housing Association





OCTOBER IS...

BLACK HISTORY MONTH

October is Black History Month (BHM). Initiatives take place across the UK with voluntary groups, local authorities, primary care trusts, and museums. Advocates of BHM use their skills and experiences to educate their community.

Some events going on in your area to celebrate Black History Month:

- African Experience, at Idea Store Whitechapel
- HAIR – History, Attitude, Identify Respect, at Rich Mix

For more information visit:
www.visitlondon.com/events/detail/8974715-black-history-month-in-london

FIRE SAFETY

ADVICE FOR RESIDENTS

PROTECTING YOU AND YOUR HOUSEHOLD

The easiest way to protect your home and family from fire is with a working smoke alarm. A smoke alarm can provide an early warning of a fire and allow you to make your escape – but only if it is working. You are more than twice as likely to die in a fire if you do not have a working smoke alarm.

- Fit smoke alarms on every level of your home.
- Test your smoke alarms regularly.
- Never disconnect or take the batteries out of your smoke alarm.

You can prevent fire from happening by taking a few simple steps:

- Don't leave cooking unattended, and avoid leaving children in the kitchen alone with cooking on the hob.
- Be especially vigilant when cooking with oil. Don't overfill chip pans and NEVER throw water on a chip pan fire.
- Make sure cigarettes are put out properly, use a proper ashtray and don't smoke in bed.
- Don't overload electrical sockets.
- Turn off appliances when not in use. Don't even leave them on standby.
- Keep matches and lighters out of reach and sight of children.
- Make sure candles are secured in a proper holder and away from materials that may catch fire – like curtains. Children shouldn't be left alone with lit candles.

Keep safe and plan your escape:

If your home is not already provided with smoke alarms, fit one in your entrance hallway (and landing of any upper or lower floor). For even better protection, fit one in your lounge and fit a heat alarm in your kitchen.

REMEMBER

- Test your smoke alarm once a week.
- Keep the exit route from your flat clear so you can escape in an emergency.



Make sure your smoke and heat alarms meet British and European standards. If you fit more than one, link them together so they all sound the alarm.

Get an electrician to fit mains-powered devices, and buy models that have a standby power supply in case of mains failure.

Your flat is in a building designed to be fire-resisting. A fire should not spread from one flat to another, so that you need not leave your home if there is a fire elsewhere in the block. That said, if in doubt, get out. Always leave if your flat is affected by smoke or heat or if told to by the fire service. Your stairway is designed to be safe for escape throughout the course of a fire. Always use the stairway to descend to ground level if escaping (never use a lift).

Do not leave your belongings or rubbish in corridors, the lift lobby or the stairway:

This could affect you and your neighbours if there was a fire. If you are in a corridor, lift lobby or stairway and you notice a fire, leave the building immediately and, if safe to do so, alert other residents in the immediate vicinity on your way out (knock on their doors).

DO NOT PUT YOURSELF AT RISK.
DO NOT RETURN TO YOUR FLAT UNTIL IT IS SAFE TO DO SO.

REMEMBER

- Close doors at night, especially the doors to the lounge and kitchen to prevent fire spreading.
- Plan your escape NOW. Be prepared and don't wait until it happens.



"FROM APRIL 2013, THE OVERALL AMOUNT OF BENEFIT YOU CAN RECEIVE WILL BE CAPPED."

The maximum amount of benefit you will be able to receive from April 2013 will be:



£500 per week for single parents



£500 per week for couples (with or without children)



£350 per week for single people without children



THE 'BENEFITS CAP'

The Government will add up how much money you get from a range of benefits, including: housing benefit, jobseeker's allowance, employment and support allowance, child benefit and carer's allowance.

If you are worried that the benefits cap will cause you financial hardship, you should seek advice now.

- You can get more information about the benefits cap by calling the Government's information line on 0845 605 7064.
- Talk to Gallions Housing Association on 0300 123 1237.

We can:

- Check your entitlement to benefits to ensure your household is claiming everything they are entitled to.
- Discuss alternative housing options.
- Help you to access employment advice/training.
- Get in touch with your local citizen's advice bureau (www.citizensadvice.org.uk) or other local advice agencies.

Remember: If you don't pay your rent, you could lose your home

This will not apply to you if:

- You receive Pension Credit
- You receive Working Tax credit
- A member of your household is claiming Disability Living Allowance, Attendance Allowance or the support element of Employment and Support Allowance.



Residents of flats in the Bexley part of Thamesmead are now able to take advantage of a dedicated food waste collection service.

NEW FOOD WASTE SERVICE LAUNCHED

Special food waste bins have been installed alongside the existing communal recycling facilities across South and Central Thamesmead. These will be used to collect food waste such as food scraps, meat, bread and rice for composting and will be emptied once a week.

Participating flats should now have received a kitchen caddy and some free paper caddy liners. Additional caddy liners are available from all Bexley libraries and Council offices for a small fee – newspaper can also be used.

Recycling food waste is as important as recycling other household rubbish like glass, cans and paper. When organic waste is put into landfill it biodegrades and has serious environmental consequences as it produces methane, a powerful greenhouse gas. Burning food waste is inefficient and wasteful as it contains so much water.

This project has been funded by a grant from the London Waste & Recycling Board as part of their flats recycling programme.



FREE SPORTS SESSIONS

FOOTBALL • CRICKET • BASKETBALL

31 OCT – 2 NOV • 12PM - 3PM

10-19 YEAR OLDS

TITMUSS AVENUE BALL COURT

NEXT TO GALLIONS' OFFICE, 90 TITMUSS AVENUE, SE28 8HL

NO NEED TO SIGN UP, JUST COME ALONG ON THE DAY!

Gallions Housing Association

Charlton Athletic Community Trust
At The Heart Of The Community

Our new **customer office** is opening soon in Thamesmead Town Centre



why not drop by?

We will open...

Monday, Tuesday, Thursday and Friday from 9am - 5pm

and Wednesday from 9am - 6pm

We will soon be closing our Titmuss Avenue customer enquiry and payment office and opening a new one at 15 Joyce Dawson Way, SE28, right in the heart of Thamesmead. This great location is a more convenient and accessible place for you to visit us.

The opening has been delayed because of an incident at one of our Service Providers' base. We are hoping that the damage which occurred as a result of the incident will be sorted out shortly. Keep a look out for more information from us about the exact opening date.

The new office will have private interview rooms, two computer terminals and a self serve kiosk where you'll be able to pay your rent online, report a repair, print helpful leaflets and much more. These computers put you in control and allow you to do some of the things our reception staff would do: but with one major advantage; you won't have to queue. Of course if you already have access to a computer you'll be able to do all these tasks in your own time.

Getting there...

Thamesmead Town Centre is well served by a number of buses including No.
N1, B11, 177, 229, 244, 401, 472, 601, 602, 609, 672 and 669.

The nearest over ground station is Abbey Wood which is approximately 25 minutes away by bus.

Meet the team!

The role of the new residents' team, and predominantly the Officers, is to work with all new residents, across all tenures, including those new to Gallions via Mutual Exchange, and provide them with knowledge and understanding of Gallions and their tenancies.

New residents are assisted to successfully complete their probationary year.

The team welcome new residents and generally provide support and a communication channel in the first year. At the end of their first year, if there are no tenancy extensions due to rent arrears or other breaches of tenancy they will be transferred to their Neighbourhood Services Officer in the Neighbourhood Services Team.



Sharon Leader
New Residents Manager



Sharon Carlile
Lettings Co-ordinator



Amanda Grainger
Allocations Officer



Pam Pickett
Allocations Officer



Paula Gent
Allocations Officer



Lizzy Stanley
New Residents Officer



Irene Taylor
New Residents Officer



Thelma McNamara
Housing Assistant

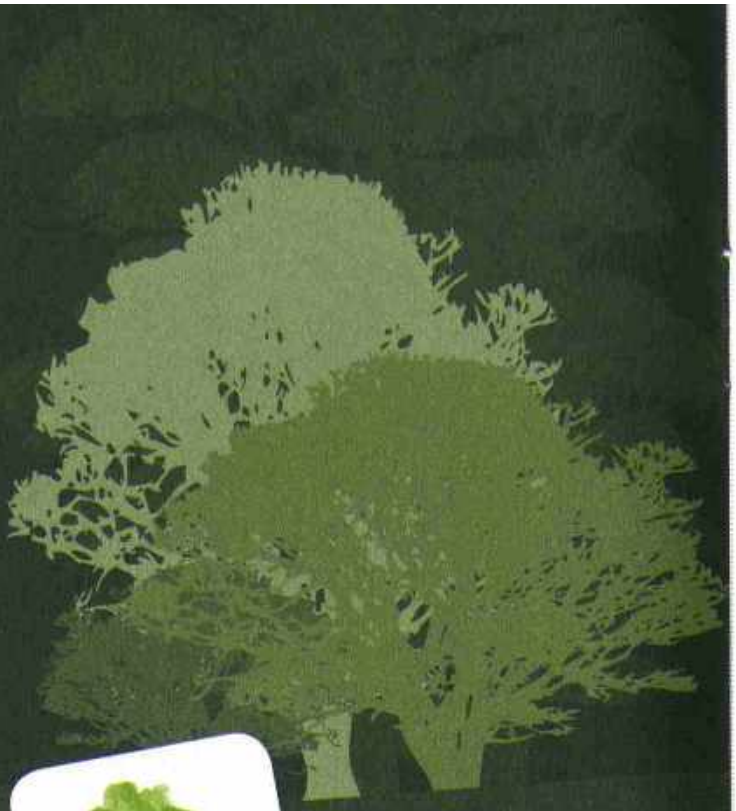
FREE TRAINING FOR RESIDENTS DIY AND EMERGENCY FIRST AID

Are you keen to learn new skills - but are on a tight budget?



Gallions is looking to team up with axis to hold do-it-yourself (DIY) free classes that will include painting and decorating skills, and basic carpentry and plumbing skills. Additionally, Gallions is also holding an emergency first aid training class.

If you're interested in either of these classes, please register with Lesley Edwards on 0208 308 4124 or ledwards2@gallionsha.co.uk



Trees for Cities

ASPEN GREEN WOODLAND PROJECT

The Aspen Green Woodland project's aim is to provide deprived areas within the Bexley Borough education and access to nature and food growing. Gallions was awarded a £50,000 grant to take part in this project. Trees for Cities will be undertaking planting and other landscaping during the planting season November to March around Gallions' properties.

CONGRATULATIONS!



In September our team of four Resident Auditors (Nigel Barnes, Carol Downes, Patricia Quainoo and Janice Butterworth) were awarded certificates following the successful completion of the first part of their training from Housing Quality Network. The team carry out short, sharp, in depth audits of particular service areas and provide reports giving strength, areas for improvement and recommendations for change. These reports go to the management team and to the GRG scrutiny panel.

The audit training is intensive and our team have shown real commitment and enthusiasm to improve services for all Gallions residents.

Well done and congratulations to the whole Resident Audit Team

Also a well done to Cherry Kent, who passed her chartered institute of housing level 2: award in Community Action in Housing.

FAIR FINANCE



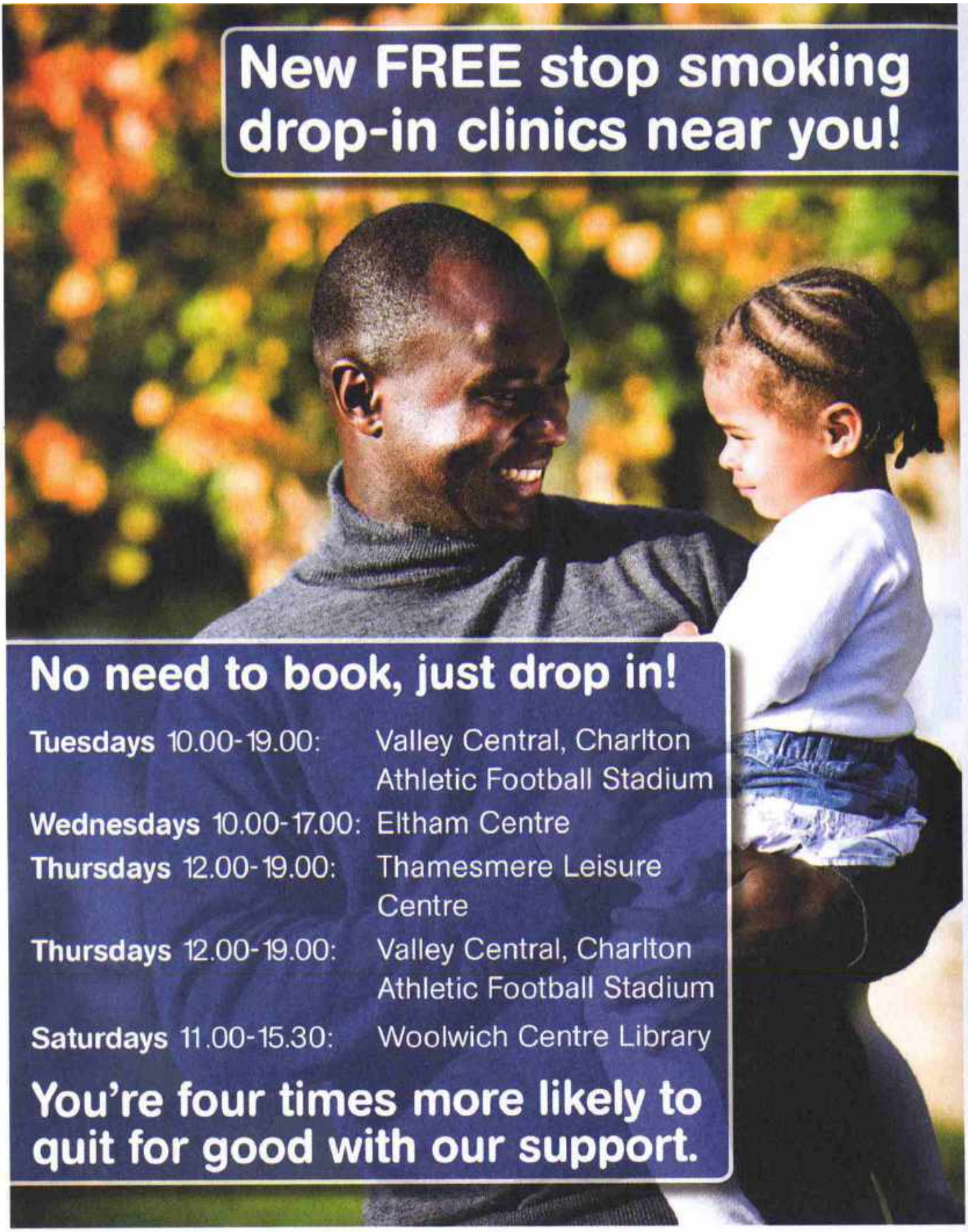
Whether the monthly accounts are in a tangle, unpaid bills are mounting up or you just need help planning for the future, some expert advice can go a long way and Fair Finance's, Fair Money Advice offers just that - advice that's confidential, impartial and totally free. With our help you can turn your money worries into a money plan.

Working in partnership with Trust Thamesmead, Fair Finance is based at the Trust Thamesmead office, 19a Joyce Dawson Way, Thamesmead Town Centre, SE28 8RA, 9:00am-5:00pm every Tuesday, Wednesday and Friday, excluding Bank Holidays.

If you need advice, would like to find out about an affordable loan or about Smart Money Workshops then book your appointment with a Fair Finance advisor, today!

Contact:

Trust Thamesmead
020 8320 4470
or
Fair Finance
020 7702 8032
Info@fairmoneyadvice.co.uk



For further information:
Visit: www.the-last-time.co.uk
Ring: 0800 587 5833
Text: QUIT to 60060

Charlton Athletic Community Trust – At The Heart Of The Community

Make This Time The Last Time

greenwich healthy living service

Thamesmead in Bloom Competition

The Thamesmead in Bloom Competition 2012 took place this summer and was delivered by the Friends of Thamesmead Parks Group supported by Gallions. Well done to all the winners!



Garden

1st	**Mr Walsh, Ormesby Way**
2nd	Ms Matthews, Disraeli Close
3rd	Mr Warr, Poplar Place

Balcony

1st	**Mr Hadwin, Shire Court**
2nd	Mrs Cowcher, Mangold Way
3rd	Mrs Larcombe, Shire Court

Communal Garden

1st	**The Birchmere Park Good Life Garden**
2nd	Buckwheat Court Communal Garden







The friends of Thamesmead Parks Group also were successful at securing £11,000 in funding from the Groundworks Transform Fund. The money will be used to create a community food growing garden on a piece of overgrown land on Titmuss Avenue.

More volunteers are wanted!

If you're interested contact Kelly Sullivan on 020 8308 4134 or email ksullivan@gallionsha.co.uk

DATES FOR YOUR DIARY

FRIGHT NIGHT CHALLENGE
WIDEHORIZONS ENVIRONMENTAL CENTRE, ELTHAM
27 Oct >> 6pm-10pm >> £5 >> www.widehorizons.org.uk >> 020 8850 1581

LORD MAYOR'S SHOW & FIREWORKS DISPLAY 2012
MANSION HOUSE, LONDON
10 Nov >> 11am-2pm, fireworks 5pm >> Free >> www.lordmayorsshow.org

COOKERY WORKSHOP
NORTH CRAY COMMUNITY CENTRE, SIDCUP
12 November >> Free >> www.bexley.gov.uk >> 020 3045 4615

CHILDREN'S NEARLY NEW SALE
WEST STREET CHILDREN'S CENTRE, ERITH
19 November >> 10am-12pm >> Free >> www.bexley.gov.uk

SLANG AT SEA
THE QUEEN'S WALK, LONDON BRIDGE
24 Nov >> 11am-12.30pm & 2pm-4pm >> Free >> www.iwm.org.uk >> 020 7940 6300

SANTA RUN 5K
GREENWICH PARK
9 December >> Registration £20 >> www.royalgreenwich.gov.uk >> 020 7803 4824

TEA DANCE
GREENWICH DANCE, GREENWICH
15 Dec >> 2pm-4pm >> £8, £6 concessions
www.greenwichdance.org.uk >> 020 8293 9741

WIN WITH OUR WORDSEARCH

In this wordsearch we have hidden the names of six popular castles around the UK. Find them all and you could win a £30 shopping voucher.

ALNWICK
DOVER
EDINBURGH
LUDLOW
WARWICK
WINDSOR

Z	Q	C	W	B	E	M	R	S	T	F	Y	H
U	K	I	Q	O	D	P	L	U	D	L	O	W
E	G	A	H	F	I	Z	K	T	L	U	Z	M
X	D	C	U	V	N	B	I	N	G	M	V	Q
M	O	I	A	J	B	W	T	E	Y	T	U	K
I	V	P	L	D	U	V	S	N	D	S	F	G
G	E	H	N	J	R	K	R	L	A	Z	E	X
Y	R	A	W	L	G	E	N	P	M	L	Q	I
D	W	K	I	Y	H	D	T	Z	Y	R	U	B
I	B	O	C	P	I	A	J	D	F	W	L	G
P	H	I	K	A	K	W	I	N	D	S	O	R
C	A	V	S	B	V	N	Z	M	C	Q	R	W
L	W	A	R	W	I	C	K	J	U	L	I	N

DID YOU KNOW...

Warwick castle was built by William the Conqueror in 1068. It has 300 dungeons and was originally built to defend the Normans from the Saxons who wanted revenge because he killed their king. The castle is now a popular tourist attraction, attracting over half a million visitors every year.

Please return your completed wordsearch and details to: Communications Team, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost RSLT-LYEG-HZAL, PO Box 268, Sidcup, DA15 0FB or drop it into our reception by 23 November 2012. The winner will be selected at random.

Name:

Address:

Telephone:

Email:

CONGRATULATIONS ... to Jacqueline Rose of Whinchat Road, Thamesmead who was the winner of our last wordsearch competition.

Michael Pavis, GRG member on the new play ground in West Thamesmead.

Autumn is now upon us and soon the leaves will be falling from the tress. It has been a successful first year of scrutiny for the Gallions' Resident Group (GRG) with new recruits to add prowess to our group. We wish you happy Halloween and happy trick o' treating!



Good news for residents of Thamesmead. There now is a new playground for children to enjoy, Gallions Reach Playground. It is located next to Gallions Hill in West Thamesmead. It is separated into two areas, an area for children 3-8 and the second area is for 8-13 year olds.

It has been open for over 6 weeks and is a big hit with local children. It provides a safe and local area for children to play and have fun. It was a long hard fought battle to get the playground there but it has finally happened. Gallions Reach Park will soon be opened and has 5 hills for great viewing points, set in 14 acres of newly planted trees and sculpted grounds. A must visit for all the family.

Southmere Village Update

The Southmere village regeneration project (Tavy Bridge) is pushing ahead with shops closing at the end of September. The consultation session at the one-stop-shop will now be held at The Link Community Centre Thamesmead from October 1st.

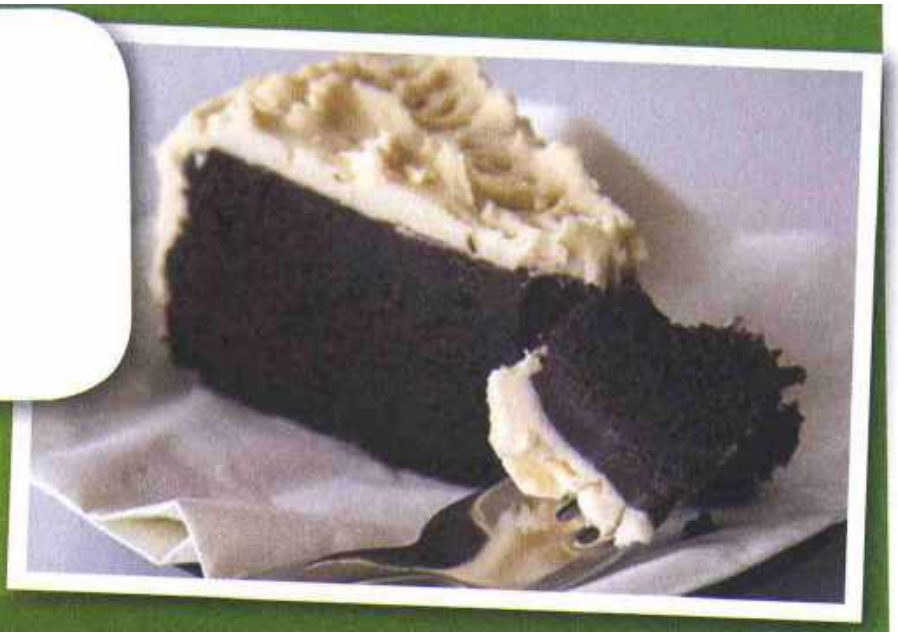
There will also be mini-road shows at Willow Bank Primary School, the Pop in Parlor and Lakeside Health Centre. The purpose of these mini-road shows is to gather opinions and input where possible, update residents on the latest news and enable them to have their say. The sessions will be on Tuesdays 9am-1pm and Thursdays 1pm-5pm.

Chris Ash, who is a member of The Tavy Bridge Regeneration Residents Action Group or (TBRRAG) , says the group aims to empower residents. "Its overall objective is for local people to have a say in the regeneration project and to be informed of the changes".

TBRRAG will be holding their Annual General Meeting on the 29 October at the Atrium from 7pm-8:30pm. There is an opportunity to join the residents' action group and to have your say in the regeneration project.

For further information please contact Tukimbo Leigh on 0208 308 4123 or email tleigh@gallionsha.co.uk

Tenants view...



Gallions resident Michael Pavis, shares a yummy desert recipe... a perfect autumn treat!

Chocolate Guinness Cake

Ingredients

250 ml Guinness
250 grams unsalted butter
75 grams cocoa powder
400 grams caster sugar
142 ml sour cream
2 medium Eggs
1 tablespoon(s) vanilla extract
275 grams Plain flour
2.5 teaspoon(s) bicarbonate of soda

For the topping

300 grams cream cheese
150 grams icing sugar
125 ml double cream
(or whipping cream)

Method

Preheat the oven to gas mark 4/180°C, and butter and line a 23cm springform tin.

Pour the Guinness into a large wide saucepan, add the butter - in spoons or slices - and heat until the butter's melted, at which time you should whisk in the cocoa and sugar. Beat the sour cream with the eggs and vanilla and then pour into the brown, buttery, beery pan and finally whisk in the flour and bicarb.

Pour the cake batter into the greased and lined tin and bake for 45 minutes to an hour. Leave to cool completely in the tin on a cooling rack, as it is quite a damp cake.

When the cake's cold, sit it on a flat platter or cake stand and get on with the icing. Lightly whip the cream cheese until smooth, sieve over the icing sugar and then beat them both together. Or do this in a processor, putting the unsieved icing sugar in first and blitz to remove lumps before adding the cheese.

Add the cream and beat again until it makes a spreadable consistency. Ice the top of the black cake so that it resembles the frothy top of the famous pint.

YOUR NEIGHBOURHOOD UPDATE

The STAR survey is a feedback service and a joint venture between the National Housing Federation and Housemark. Gallions wants to thank residents who took part in the survey. Mike Robinson, Planning and Performance Manager, gives us a commentary on the results

The STAR survey results are in and it is good news, which is great for residents and Gallions. It means that the hard work and services that we are providing are proving to be a success with residents. The survey found that the following areas had improved:

1) Overall satisfaction with Gallions has increased by 3% since 2007.

2) Satisfaction with neighbourhood has increased by 15% in 2007. Bringing the total to 74% satisfaction.

3) Satisfaction with cleanliness of communal areas overall has increased by a total score of 19% since 2007.

4) Whilst this is mainly due to the caretaker approach, satisfaction with parks and green spaces has also increased by 7%.

5) Satisfaction with keeping communal areas in good repair has increased by 17% since 2007.

6) Satisfaction in contact with Gallions has increased by 3% since 2007, with an average score of 80%.

7) Satisfaction with repairs and maintenance remains high; although some scores have dropped slightly since 2007.

8) Satisfaction with value for money provided by rent has increased by 3% since 2007.

9) Satisfaction with home has been maintained and is up to 2% since 2010. It was 77% in 2010, now it is at 79% satisfaction.

Mike explained that some areas of the business had improved. 'Mostly the increase in satisfaction came from the neighbourhood's department, with a big improvement in the environmental services area.'

The areas that residents are most concerned about are: dog fouling, rubbish and litter. The Neighbourhoods department has devised a strategy to tackle these issues for residents, in hopes that it can increase satisfaction in the three areas. Possibly one of the other big improvements of the survey was the fact that satisfaction with where residents live has gone up. With Crossway as the most popular place to live followed by Manorway.

The Moorings is the least happy with Gallions services. Hopefully with Gallions major project The South Thamesmead Regeneration Framework' the satisfaction levels with neighbourhoods will only go up.

In summary Mike said, 'the general consensus is good. Residents are telling us through the survey that they are seeing the changes Gallions is making. However, there is still work to be done for improving services.'

STAR SURVEY HIGHLIGHTS...





74%

Satisfaction with neighbourhoods has increased by 15% in 2007 and 7% in 2010. Bringing the total to 74% satisfaction.

80%

Satisfaction in contact with Gallions has increased by £3% since 2007, with an average score of 80%

79%

Satisfaction with home has been maintained and is up to 2% since 2010. It was 77% in 2010, now it is at 79% satisfaction.



PERCENTAGE OF SATISFACTION WITH COMMUNAL SPACES

	2010	2012	INCREASE
Lifts	58%	77%	+19%
Communal areas	58%	78%	+20%
Walkways & paths	63%	70%	+7%
Car parking	56%	69%	+13%
Garages	36%	63%	+27%
Parks & green spaces	68%	73%	+5%



INTERVIEW WITH NIGEL

GALLIONS BOARD MEMBER

THE NEWEST ADDITION TO GALLIONS' BOARD, COMMUNITY CHAMPION, FORMER UPS WORKER TURNED BLACK CAB DRIVER, NIGEL BARNES IS THIS EDITION'S BOARD MEMBER FEATURED. HE KINDLY SAT DOWN WITH US TO TALK A BIT ABOUT HIMSELF AND WHY HE GOT INVOLVED.

For those who have met Nigel in person it is easy to see why he was chosen to represent Gallions on the board along with five others. He is someone who is extremely friendly, positive and knowledgeable, but also someone who can admit that he has a lot to learn from other board members.

Being a board member takes great patience and listening, skills something that Nigel, a magistrate is well acquainted with. 'I look at it this way; I'm the same as the person that's standing in front of me, listening skills are what I think makes a good magistrate.'

'If I can prevent just one child from walking out of the courtroom who won't be back, I've done my job.' Currently in the UK 95 % of criminal cases are resolved in front of a magistrate and Nigel encourages anyone who is interested to look into it.

Possibly one of Nigel's most relevant qualifications for Gallions' board is the fact that he is a resident of Gallions and lives in Thamesmead. 'I first thought I should get involved and saw an article in Thamesview looking for resident auditors and after becoming a resident auditor, it was interesting for me to get an inside look on what goes on , and to see first hand how good Gallions is at doing what they do.'

As for the future of Gallions board? 'I think it's good going forward to have residents' perspective, but also to have business knowledge is important. Gallions has a great vision for the future, and everything will come together with regeneration projects. I think it will once again be a place where people will want to live in London.'

Nigel wanted to take the time to encourage other residents to get involved. 'There are many ways that residents can help shape the future of Gallions and the services it provides. If you have some spare time I strongly encourage you to get involved and help improve the community for all.'

LOOK AFTER THE AREA...

The removal of Dumped Rubbish is costing Gallions more than £200,000 per year in collecting rubbish which has not been put out correctly for collection by local authority.



Residents complain about Dumped Rubbish more than any other issue.

...IT'S YOUR HOME!

We have listened to your concerns and have now employed Ernel Cottrell as a Refuse Enforcement Officer.



We work in partnership with the Local Authority and those found responsible could be liable to a **£80 Fixed Penalty Notice** along with action for breach of tenancy. Dumping rubbish or failing to place rubbish in correct container is Anti Social Behaviour.

Love where you Live.org

Team Gallions Environmental Services

Any questions in relation to waste or should you wish to report a person dumping rubbish please contact us confidentially on **0300 123 1237**.

We want our neighbourhood to stay clean so please follow these steps to avoid enforcement action:

- If you live in a flat with a rubbish chute, please place the rubbish in a suitable bag: don't use large bags as these often block the chutes.
- Place the correct articles within the recycle bins and NOT left by the side.
- If you live in a house only put your rubbish out on collection day.
- Do not leave any items or bags on the landings of a block or on the street.

Make a change in your community



GET INVOLVED TODAY!

Residents' views are important to Gallions and below are some examples of ways you can get involved in your community and the management of your home. Please contact us if you are interested in residents' groups at Gallions.

Gallions' Residents Group (GRG) have a small pot of funding available for community groups to apply for specific projects (not ongoing running costs). For more information and an application form or to sign up for one of the groups below, please contact Helen Chambers hchambers@gallionsha.co.uk 0300 123 1237 ext 4098

Gallions' Residents Group (GRG) – the scrutiny panel that looks at Gallions performance against regulatory standards - will be looking at the tenancy standard in November and December and would like to know if you have any comments. The tenancy standard covers things like applying for housing, the allocation of housing and mutual exchanges and the support given to residents to sustain their tenancies . (For more information on the Tenancy Standard please go to www.homesandcommunities.co.uk)

Thamesmead Talk Tuesdays - a group for residents interested in disability issues meets the first Tuesday of every month at 2.00pm at Lakeview Court, Thamesmead. Come along and meet new people. Have your say on things that matter to you.
Thamesview Residents' Panel - this group



looks at the Thamesview magazine. They are responsible for sourcing and writing stories as well as scrutinising the publication and making it a useful and informative magazine for residents.

If you have any comments on how Gallions does in this respect (good or bad!) please let GRG know via Helen Chambers hchambers@gallionsha.co.uk 0300 123 1237 ext 4098

In April our team of Resident Auditors recently looked in depth at Team Gallions Environmental Services. Changes coming from the Auditors report included reviewing the Team Gallions (TG) service standards in consultation with residents, changing the way that graffiti removal is reported so that it is more accurate and changes to the way TG operatives are managed.

The Resident Auditors have more recently looked at how Gallions provides aids and adaptations for disabled residents. We'll let you know what improvements this report has led to in the next issue.

BOREDOM BUSTERS...
THINGS TO DO IN HALF-TERM
- OCTOBER 2012 -

"How about this for an action packed week to look forward to?"

BAMM!







Half Term Boredom Busters in Thamesmead

We have some really exciting news for all 5-16 year olds from our friends at Trust Thamesmead.

They've put together a programme of activities that make up an action packed week during half term between 29 October and 2 November.

What's even more exciting is some of the things they've lined up for you are taking place in The Link Thamesmead, the brilliant, world-class community hub that has just opened in Belvedere Road (under the Harrow Manor Way flyover). The others will be based at facilities close to Sporting Club Thamesmead, another of the Trust's fantastic venues which will be fully-open very soon.

Activities on offer will feature sports coaching including football, golf and tennis, as well as gym sessions, hip hop/street dance classes and drama workshops.

Want to try something different? There will be digital photography and motorcycle mechanics. You can even learn how to make delicious cookies and cakes!

For nature enthusiasts a trip to Eagle Heights in Kent is also planned.

To celebrate the end of a busy week all the children and young people taking part are being invited to a free Halloween Party at The Link on Friday 2 November from 7.00-9.00pm when there will be a fancy dress competition, games and food (under 8's to be accompanied by an adult).

A brochure is now available outlining all the information you will need to take part in any of these half term activities, including prices, times, places and what you need to bring with you. Please note that the age range for activities will vary.

Look out for a copy in school and at your local library or sign up now to receive one by calling The Link Thamesmead on 020 8320 4499 or emailing contact@thelinkthamesmead.co.uk

COME CELEBRATE
HALLOWEEN AT THE LINK!

Halloween Party, presented by
Gallions Housing Association and Trust Thamesmead



FREE EVENT



7:00-9:00pm
Friday 2 November
5-14 year olds*

Join us for an evening of ghost and ghouls, fun and games at our optional fancy dress, Halloween themed party full of music and mayhem.

This event is a first come first - served event. People can request tickets by going to The Link in Belvedere Road (under the Harrow Manor Way flyover) between 10am to 6pm Monday - Friday

*Under 8's need to be accompanied by an adult

Kidsview WORDSEARCH

We have hidden the names of six Disney characters in this wordsearch. Find them all and you could win a DVD pack.

Q	L	R	E	E	S	R	E	T	L	Y	K	U
J	I	A	O	G	P	T	A	M	S	E	D	W
A	F	P	G	B	H	A	J	X	K	A	L	L
L	K	U	I	C	F	R	U	B	A	M	B	I
A	Q	N	W	D	E	Z	R	S	T	W	Y	Q
D	L	Z	K	O	O	A	I	A	J	S	U	D
D	F	E	G	G	H	N	J	I	K	C	L	M
I	E	L	S	C	R	V	A	B	Q	N	M	U
N	Q	R	W	K	E	I	R	H	Y	U	U	L
B	O	C	P	V	A	F	D	R	F	V	Z	A
H	C	I	N	D	E	R	E	L	L	A	X	N
U	V	A	X	D	N	G	M	J	Q	L	B	W
E	C	R	B	T	M	Y	U	U	T	I	R	O



ALADDIN • CINDERELLA • MULAN

BAMBI • TARZAN • RAPUNZEL

This competition is just for kids under 12. Please return your completed wordsearch and details to: Communications Team, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost RSLT-LYEG-HZAL, PO Box 268, Sidcup, DA15 0FB or drop it into our reception by 23 November 2012. The winner will be selected at random.

Child's name:

Parent's name:

Address:

Telephone:

WELL DONE ...to Comonniasha of Lensbury Way, Abbey Wood who was the winner of our last competition.